

Nellie Counts to Ten

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Nellie the hedgehog was learning to count.

She could count to three.

One, two, three.

But ten felt very far away.

"I want to count to ten," she told her grandma.

"You will," said Grandma. "Let's find ten acorns."

Nellie felt excited.

They walked into the autumn woods.

"Look for acorns," said Grandma.

Nellie found the first acorn under an oak tree.

"One," she said.

She found the second near a mossy stone.

"Two," she said.



She found the third by a twisted root.

"Three," she said.

She felt proud.

Then she found a fourth, a fifth, and a sixth.

"Four, five, six," she counted.

Her basket was getting heavy.

She felt strong.

Then she spotted a seventh under a leaf.

"Seven," she said.

An eighth sat by the stream.

"Eight," she said.

A ninth hid behind a mushroom.

"Nine," she said.

She felt so close.

But where was number ten?

Nellie looked everywhere.

Under leaves.



Behind stones.

Inside a hollow log.

No tenth acorn.

She felt worried.

"What if there are only nine?" she asked.

Grandma smiled.

"Count your basket again," she said. "Slowly."

Nellie counted.

One, two, three, four, five, six, seven, eight, nine.

Still nine.

Then Grandma pointed up.

A tenth acorn was stuck in Nellie's own spiky back!

It had hitched a ride.

"Ten!" laughed Nellie. "Ten, ten, ten!"

That was three times she said it.

She felt joyful.



She had counted all the way to ten.

Grandma clapped.

"You did it, Nellie."

That night, Nellie lined up her ten acorns by her bed.

One, two, three, four, five.

Six, seven, eight, nine, ten.

She yawned a tiny hedgehog yawn.

Her eyes grew heavy.

Sleep now, little counter.

Dream of acorns lined up in a row.

Moral: *Take it one step at a time, and you will get there.*

The End